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Identity Shift

Who You Are in Christ

Purpose

To help disciples shift from their own limited perception of themselves to embrace who God says they are, and to equip them with an Identity Battle Plan for ongoing spiritual warfare.

Why This Matters

You've broken strongholds in Week 9. Now it's time to build up the truth. The enemy doesn't just attack with lies—he attacks your identity. When you know who you are in Christ and have Scripture to back it up, you can stand firm when the enemy comes. This isn't just a nice teaching—this is warfare training.

Preparation (Before the Meeting)

Leaders:

- Pray for Holy Spirit to reveal true identity over each disciple
- Print Identity Battle Plan worksheets (one per disciple)
- Have Bibles ready for Scripture searching
- Prepare to share your own identity journey
- Review the diagram teaching (Independent/Insecure/Arrogant/Humility axes)

Disciples:

- Come ready to see yourself the way God sees you
- Bring your Bible and a pen
- Be prepared to hear truth that might challenge your self-perception

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Meeting Structure (90 minutes)

1. Opening: The Identity Transfer (8 minutes)

Leader opens:

> "Tonight we're talking about identity. Here's the truth: Christ has already transferred His identity to you. The moment you became a Christian, you received a new identity. You are no longer who you were. You are who He says you are.
>
> But here's the problem: just because Christ has given us this new identity doesn't mean we automatically experience it. We have to come into agreement with it. We have to believe it. We have to fight for it.
>
> Tonight, we're going to discover the gap between how you see yourself and how God sees you. And we're going to close that gap."

Opening Prayer:

> "God, open our eyes to see ourselves the way You see us. Expose the lies we've believed about ourselves. Reveal the truth. Give us the courage to deny our own opinions and come into agreement with Yours. In Jesus' name."

2. The Mirror Test: How Do You See Yourself? (7 minutes)

Leader guides:

> "Let's start with an honest assessment. I want you to answer this question—not the 'Christian' answer, but the real answer:
>
> **When you look at yourself in the mirror, what do you see? What kind of person are you? What do you observe about yourself and your character?**
>
> Take 4-5 minutes and write it down. Be honest. This is between you and God."

Don’t say a word. Move on to the next section. We will work through these after completing the next question.

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3. Listening Prayer: How Does God See You? (10 minutes)

"Now we're going to practice the listening prayer skills you learned in Week 6. But this time, you're not listening for someone else—you're listening for yourself.

Close your eyes. Take a deep breath. Invite the Holy Spirit into this moment.

Ask God this question: **'God, when You look at me, what do You see?'**

Don't force it. Don't make something up. Just wait. Listen. What is He saying?

You might hear:

- A word or phrase ('beloved,' 'strong,' 'chosen,' 'warrior')
- A picture or image
- A Scripture that comes to mind
- A feeling of His affection or pride over you

Write down everything you hear. Don't filter it. Don't dismiss it as 'not spiritual enough.' Just receive it."

(Give them 7 minutes of silence. Play soft instrumental worship music. Leaders pray silently over the room. Watch for people who seem stuck—be ready to help privately.)

Check-in:

"Has everyone received something? If you're still waiting, that's okay—keep listening. If you've received something, hold onto it. We're going to explore this."

4. The Identity Gap: Comparing the Two (10 minutes)

"Now look at what you wrote. What do you notice about the way you see yourself and the way that God sees you? Why is there a difference? Why is there an identity gap?

Here's the truth: **One of you must be wrong. One of you must be incorrect.** And we all know that God is not incorrect. His perspective is the true perspective. Your perception of yourself is distorted by lies, wounds, shame, and the enemy's accusations.

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> **We all need an identity shift.** Not one of us has a perfect perspective. So we must deny our own opinion of ourselves and come into agreement with His.
>
> **Who He says I am is who I truly am."**

5. Teaching: The Gideon Encounter (15 minutes)

Leader teaches:

"Let me show you what an identity shift looks like in the Bible.

Read Judges 6:11-16 (or summarize):

God meets Gideon in a winepress. Gideon is hiding from the Midianites, trying to thresh wheat in a place where you crush grapes. This guy is scared, doing the best he can under terrible circumstances.

And God shows up and says: **'The Lord is with you, mighty man of valor!'**

But Gideon doesn't receive it. He reminds God that He's got the wrong guy:

> *'O my Lord, how can I save Israel? Indeed my clan is the weakest in Manasseh, and I am the least in my father's house.'*

Gideon knew God was mighty. He believed the stories of God's faithfulness. But his personal perception of himself was completely based on earthly standards—his family's status, his position, his résumé.

God calls him a 'mighty man of valor' while he's hiding in fear.

And notice: God doesn't correct him. God doesn't argue with him. God just says, **'I will be with you, and you will strike down all the Midianites.'**

Sometimes who Jesus says we are is so far off from our personal perception, we need sign after sign to actually grab hold of it by faith.

And God is willing to meet us there. He's not afraid of our unbelief. He's not intimidated by our small thinking. He uses us in our weakness to glorify His name.

Here's the question:

When God speaks over you—when He calls you something you don't feel like you are—will you come into agreement with what He says? Or will you try to talk yourself out of the identity He has given you?

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This is false humility.

False humility is exalting your opinion of you over what God says about you.

It's not humble to say 'I'm nothing' when God says 'You are My beloved son, My beloved daughter, a mighty warrior, a chosen vessel.'

True humility is agreeing with God—even when it feels too good to be true."

Pause for emphasis:

"So let me ask you again: **When God looks at you, what does He see?**

Whatever He just spoke to you—that's the truth. Not how you feel. Not your track record. Not your failures. **His word over you is the truth.**"

Declare together:

> "Everyone say this out loud with me: **'I am who Jesus says I am.'"**

(Lead them in declaring it 2-3 times with increasing boldness.)

6. Teaching: Do You Agree? (15 minutes)

"As a follower of Jesus, we have one job: **To say 'Amen.'**

Amen = I agree.

Read 2 Corinthians 1:18-20:

> *'But as surely as God is faithful, our message to you is not "Yes" and "No." For the Son of God, Jesus Christ, who was preached among you by us—by me and Silas and Timothy—was not "Yes" and "No," but in him it has always been "Yes." For no matter how many promises God has made, they are "Yes" in Christ. And so through him the "Amen" is spoken by us to the glory of God.'*

God's promises are 'Yes' in Christ. Our job is to say **'Amen'**—to agree with what He says.

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Two statements we need to come into agreement with.

1. **Who God says He is** (God Dependent)
2. **Who God says I am** (God Confident)

If I come into agreement with these two statements, I will function in the likeness of Christ. That is my identity. And that is your identity."

[Draw the "Identity Diagram" on a whiteboard or have it printed on paper beforehand. This resource is provided in your DNA Group Dashboard.]

"We have this cross. At the center is **Christ**—true humility and complete God dependence.

Horizontal axis (left to right):

- Left = **Insecure** (I think too little of myself)
- Right = **Arrogant** (I think too much of myself)

Vertical axis (top to bottom):

- Top = **Independent** (I don't need God or others)
- Bottom = **Co-dependent** (I rely on one person to validate me or make me feel worthy)

At the center of the cross is Christ:

- **True Humility** – I agree with who God says I am
- **God Dependent** – I agree with who God says He is

Christ is not arrogant. He's not insecure. He's not independent. He's not codependent.

He is **God Dependent** and He walks in **True Humility.**

God Dependent means that He depends on the community of God as the Trinity **and His body**—because you cannot separate the body from the head. We are all together in this.

This is **not codependency**, where you rely on one person to make you feel a certain way or to validate you. That's unhealthy.

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God dependence means I depend on God and I depend on the body of Christ as God's design for community and strength.

So how do I function in true humility and God dependence?

To function in true humility: I must agree with who God says I am.

To function in God dependence: I must agree with who God says He is.

If I come into agreement with these two statements, I will function in the likeness of Christ."

Discussion Question:

"Where do you tend to fall on this diagram?

- Do you struggle with insecurity? (thinking too little of yourself)
- Do you struggle with arrogance? (thinking you don't need God's help)
- Do you struggle with independence? (trying to do it all on your own)
- Do you struggle with codependency? (needing one person's approval to feel okay)

Jesus is calling you to the center—to true humility and God dependence."

7. Identity Battle Plan Launch (15 minutes)

Leader teaches:

"Okay, here's where this gets practical. Now we're going to create a tool that you can use for the rest of your life. It's called your **Identity Battle Plan.**

When the enemy attacks your identity—and he will—you need to be ready to fight back. Not with your feelings. Not with your willpower. But with **Scripture.**

The Identity Battle Plan has two columns:

Column 1: Who I Am (with Scripture to back it up) **Column 2: Who He Is** (the corresponding attribute of God)

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For example:

- **Who I am:** 'More than conquerors' — Romans 8:37
- **Who He is:** 'Gracious giver' — Romans 8:32

When the enemy whispers 'You're a failure,' you pull out your Identity Battle Plan and say: **'No. I am more than a conqueror through Christ who loves me. God is a gracious giver who did not spare His own Son but gave Him up for me. How will He not also freely give me all things?'**

You're not just fighting with positive thinking. You're fighting with **the Word of God.**

This is your weapon. This is how you refresh your agreement with who God says you are."

Activity: Start Your Identity Battle Plan (15 minutes)

Leader guides:

"I'm handing out the Identity Battle Plan worksheet. It has two columns and blank lines.

Here's what we're going to do for the next 15 minutes:

1. **Ask God:** 'Who am I to You?' Write down what He says.
2. **Search Scripture:** Use your Bible or ask someone in the group to help you find a verse that backs up that identity.
3. **Find the corresponding attribute of God:** Who does God have to be for you to be that?

For example:

- If God says 'You are forgiven,' then God must be 'Merciful and full of grace.'
- If God says 'You are strong,' then God must be 'My strength and my shield.'

Your goal tonight is to fill in **at least 3-5 lines.** But this is a lifelong tool. You'll keep adding to this. You'll keep finding more Scriptures. You'll keep discovering who you are in Christ.

Important:

You will not be graded on this. This Battle Plan is for **you.** This is so when the enemy comes and attacks your identity, you have something to fight back with.

Let me be very clear: **It's not IF the enemy attacks you. It's WHEN.**

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He will attack your identity. He will whisper lies. He will try to get you to come into agreement with shame, fear, inadequacy, and condemnation.

You must be prepared to fight back with Scripture. You must be prepared to declare your identity and refresh your agreement with who God says you are.

Let's get started. If you need help finding Scripture, ask. If you're stuck, ask God to speak. Leaders, we're going to walk around and help."

(Give them 15 minutes. Play soft music. Leaders circulate and help. Encourage them. Affirm what they're writing. Pray over them as they work.)

8. Declarations & Closing (10 minutes)

Leader invites:

"We're going to close by declaring what God has spoken.

One by one, I want you to share:

1. One 'Who I am' statement from your Battle Plan
2. The Scripture that backs it up

Just one. Make it bold. Declare it out loud. Let the group hear it. Let the enemy hear it. Let YOUR SOUL hear it."

(Go around the circle. Each person declares one identity statement.)

Example:

Disciple: "I am beloved. Colossians 3:12 says I am God's chosen, holy, and dearly loved."

Group response: "Amen." / "Yes, Lord." / "We receive that."

(Continue around the circle until everyone has shared.)

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Leader closes with prayer:

"Father, thank You for what You've done tonight. You've opened our eyes to see ourselves the way You see us. You've given us weapons to fight back when the enemy attacks.

We seal this truth by the blood of Jesus. We declare that we are who You say we are. Not who we feel like. Not who our past says. Not who the enemy accuses us of being.

We are Yours. We are loved. We are chosen. We are strong in You.

Guard these truths in our hearts. When the lies come back—and they will—remind us of tonight. Remind us of Your Word. Give us the courage to stand firm in our identity.

In Jesus' mighty name, Amen."

Commission:

"You just created a weapon. Your Identity Battle Plan is not a one-time exercise. It's a lifelong tool.

Here's your assignment:

1. **Keep adding to it.** Every time God speaks a new truth over you, write it down with Scripture.
2. **Use it when the enemy attacks.** When lies come, pull out your Battle Plan and declare the truth out loud.
3. **Refresh your agreement daily.** Read through your Battle Plan during your 3D or 4D time. Remind yourself who you are.

This isn't IF the enemy attacks. It's WHEN.

Be ready."

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Between Meetings (Leader Follow-Up)

1. Individual Check-Ins

- Text each disciple within 24 hours: "How are you doing after last night? What's one truth God spoke over you that's sticking with you?"
- Encourage them to add to their Identity Battle Plan throughout the week

2. Encourage Daily Reinforcement

- "Read through your Identity Battle Plan every morning this week."
- "Journal about one 'Who I am' statement in your 3D Journal."
- "Pray one identity statement over yourself during your 4D Prayer time."
- "Write one identity truth on a notecard and put it somewhere you'll see it daily (mirror, car dashboard, phone lock screen)."

3. Watch for Spiritual Warfare

- The enemy will attack identity this week. Warn disciples in your follow-up:
    - "If lies start coming back this week, don't just ignore them—renounce them out loud and declare the truth from your Identity Battle Plan."

4. Celebrate Testimonies

- In your group chat, ask: "What's one way this week that knowing your identity in Christ changed how you responded to something?"
- Share testimonies of identity breakthroughs at the start of next week's meeting

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Coaching Tips for Leaders

If someone can't hear God during listening prayer:

- Don't force it. Quietly pray with them.
- Ask gently: "What's something you've always wished God would say about you? Ask Him if that's true."
- Sometimes people can't hear because they're afraid of what God will say. Reassure them: "God is kind. He's not going to shame you."

If someone struggles to find Scripture:

- Help them search. Use a Bible concordance or a phone app.
- Suggest starting with Romans 8, Ephesians 1-2, 1 Peter 2, or Colossians 3.
- If they're stuck, give them one to start: "You are loved—1 John 3:1."

If someone writes an identity that doesn't align with Scripture:

- Gently correct: "I love what you're hearing, but let's make sure it lines up with Scripture. Can we find a verse that confirms that?"
- Point them to God's Word as the ultimate authority on identity.

If someone is emotional:

- This is normal and healthy. Identity is deeply personal.
- Let them cry. Sit with them. Offer a tissue, a hand on the shoulder (if appropriate), or just silent presence.
- Pray quietly: "God, meet them here. Seal this truth in their heart."

If the group is hesitant or surface-level:

- Leaders go first. Model vulnerability.
- Share your own identity struggle and what God has spoken over you.
- "I'll go first so you can see what this looks like."

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Good Signs:

- Tears, emotional release (Holy Spirit is moving)
- Breakthrough moments ("I've never seen myself that way before." / "That's exactly what I needed to hear.")
- Boldness in declaring identity
- Lightness/freedom after the session ("I feel different.")
- Disciples writing passionately on their Battle Plans

Red Flags:

- Complete resistance to the process (may indicate deeper wounds or lies)
- Inability to receive truth even after God speaks (may need more time or ministry)
- Shame or self-condemnation after hearing God's voice (address immediately: "There is no condemnation in Christ. You are loved. You are safe here.")
- Someone trying to minimize or joke through the process (may be a defense mechanism—gently call it out)

Key Takeaways

For Disciples:

- Christ has given you a new identity, but you must come into agreement with it
- False humility is exalting your opinion over God's opinion
- True humility = agreeing with who God says you are
- God dependence = agreeing with who God says He is
- Your Identity Battle Plan is a weapon for ongoing spiritual warfare
- It's not IF the enemy attacks your identity—it's WHEN. Be ready.

For Leaders:

- Identity is deeply personal. Create space for vulnerability and emotion.
- The Identity Battle Plan is a lifelong tool. Encourage disciples to keep adding to it.
- Watch for identity attacks this week. Follow up and remind disciples to use their Battle Plan.